Kisht Collections

Technical design document. Brief 4: field collections with AI prioritisation for an MSME lender in Indore.

GitHub: https://github.com/palvk4469/Kisht
Live app: https://kist-collection.duckdns.org
Demo logins and run steps: `deployment.md`
Labels: A# is an assumption (all listed in the appendix). D# is a decision, recorded with its reason in `docs/DECISIONS.md`.

1. The problem

Company A's officers get names on WhatsApp each morning, and outcomes come back the same way. Promises live in notebooks, and head office rebuilds the picture in Excel every week. The head of collections cannot see what happened in between.

The brief puts the cost at ₹1.63 crore a year: ₹1.134 crore from loans rolling past 30 days overdue, and ₹49.5 lakh of manual reporting. Success means the roll rate falling from 22% to 16% in four months, 95% of visits logged the same day, and the weekly Excel stopped.

So the design rests on three things an officer or auditor would notice at once:

- **The list must be trusted.** Every loan says why it is there, in plain words, and a manager can overrule it.
- **Logging must never fail in the field.** Weak signal is the normal case, so the phone is the first place anything is saved.
- **The contact rule must be provable.** RBI limits contact to 8 am–7 pm, so the app blocks it and keeps a record of every attempt, including blocked ones.

2. What was built

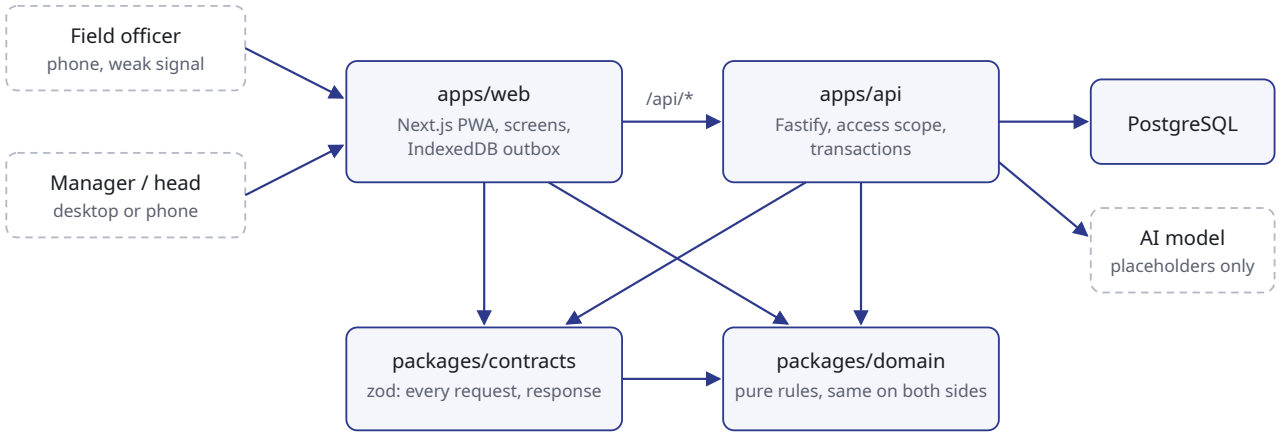
Brief	Built
Daily CSV import, auto-assignment	Preview first, with row-level errors, then commit. Assigned by pincode, then lowest workload, keeping a loan with its officer where possible (A3). If the file is late, officers keep the latest list, marked with its date (A29).
Officer list, call and map, outcomes with GPS	Ranked list with reasons. An outcome takes three taps. GPS is attached if it arrives within 1.5 seconds and never holds up logging. Loans that are new, newly assigned or part-paid since the last list are marked (A32).
Promise reminders	To borrower and officer, on approved wording, held outside 8 am–7 pm, stopped once the promise settles or the loan is disputed (A22).
AI priority score, top three reasons	A logistic regression. Reasons are real terms of the model's sum (section 6).

AI-drafted reminders	A model reached through OpenRouter rewords an approved template and never sees borrower details. Sent only on the officer's tap (section 6).
Manager dashboard, activity log	Roll rate by branch and week, broken promises, weekly back-test, and every attempt with its visit location checked against the borrower's address. The full contact log downloads as CSV for an audit (A31).
Start and end the day on WhatsApp	My day sums up the officer's day, unsent work included, and sends it to the branch on WhatsApp as counts only. Managers see each officer's day as phones sync (A30).
Hard parts	Offline logging with sync, and the contact block (section 7).
Hindi, minimal design, one hand	Every screen in Hindi and English, light and dark themes, 48 px targets, WCAG 2.1 AA checked in CI (section 9).

Everything in "Must have" was built, beyond the required core slice. Payments, messages and outside systems are mocked as the brief allows: a "sent" message is written to `MessageLog` and labelled as simulated on screen (D11).

3. Architecture

A modular monolith: one API, one web app and three small packages with one job each. An eight-week project with one team does not need microservices, and a lender's auditor benefits from having a single place to read each rule.



Solid boxes are ours. The web app may not import the database: Biome fails CI if it tries.

Decision	Why
Rules live in a pure `domain` package (D1, D9)	The button greyed out on the phone and the rejection on the server run the same code, so they cannot disagree.
One `contracts` package (D16)	Fastify validates and serialises through the same zod schemas the web parses with. A field not in the contract, such as a phone number, cannot leak. OpenAPI docs are generated from them.
One access-control module (D6, D17)	Every loan, officer and batch query takes its filter from `scope.ts`. Out of scope returns 404, so IDs cannot be probed.

Next.js proxies `/api/*` (D3)	The browser only talks to one origin, so cookies stay first-party and the API needs no CORS.
Boundaries enforced in CI (D18)	A dependency rule that is only a convention erodes. Lint fails on a wrong import, and business rules must keep 90% test coverage.

4. Data model

PostgreSQL through Prisma. Three properties do most of the work: facts are appended and never edited, each day's list is a snapshot, and uniqueness is enforced by the database.

Table	Holds	Why it matters
`Borrower`, `Loan`	Who owes, in which branch, EMI, contact paused	The borrower's preferred language drives reminders
`ImportBatch`, `LoanSnapshot`	Each upload; each loan's outstanding and days overdue per day	Roll rate needs daily history (D10)
`Assignment`	Which officer, from when to when	A partial unique index allows one current officer per loan
`PriorityScore`	Probability, rupees at stake, reasons, model version, per day	The back-test judges the scores actually given
`ContactAttempt`	Channel, device and corrected time, GPS, allowed, block reason; client UUID unique	The RBI record. A retry cannot store twice
`Outcome`, `PromiseToPay`	Paid, promise, not reachable, dispute; promise date, amount, status	A partial unique index allows one pending promise per loan
`Payment`	Detected from each import (A8)	Decides whether a promise was kept (A7)
`ListOverride`	A manager's move, with its reason	Shown to the officer and audited
`Reminder`, `ReminderDraft`, `MessageLog`	Scheduled reminders, officer drafts, what was "sent"	Each draft records why any AI wording was rejected
`BacktestRun`, `AuditLog`	Finished weekly results; sensitive actions	A finished week never changes (D26)

5. Main flows

Morning import

1. A manager uploads the CSV and sees what it will change, with errors listed by Excel row number. Nothing is written yet.
2. If today's file is late, officers keep yesterday's list with a note giving its date, and the dashboard asks the manager to upload (A29).

3. On commit, a transaction claims the batch, so a double submit does nothing, and plans again from the current database.
4. Loans, snapshots, payments, assignments and scores are written, and open promises are resolved as kept, partial or broken.

An officer's day

1. The list opens at once from the phone's copy and refreshes behind it (D27). The whole day is one payload, so every loan opens with no signal (D22).
2. Loans that are new, newly assigned or part-paid since the previous list are marked, so the officer knows before the first call (A32).
3. Tap a loan, tap what happened, confirm: three taps. A promise's date chip is itself the confirmation.
4. The event is saved on the phone first and sent when it can be.
5. In the evening, My day adds up the day, unsent entries included, and sends it to the branch on WhatsApp as counts only (A30). The manager sees every officer's day on Activity as phones sync.

Promises and reminders

A promise schedules reminders for 10 am the day before and 9 am on the day to the borrower, and 8:30 am to the officer (A22). The next import decides whether it was kept. A dispute stops all contact until a manager clears it (A12).

Managers

Managers open the dashboard rather than waiting for Friday. Roll rate counts loans 1–30 days overdue on day D that are 31+ on day D+30 (A6). This is the brief's 31–60: days overdue rise at most one a day, so a loan at 30 or under can't pass 60 in thirty days. They can reorder a list or reassign a loan, each with a reason the officer sees and an audit entry, and they can inspect any attempt in the activity log.

6. How the AI works

Priority score: a model, on purpose

A lender must be able to explain why one borrower was chased before another, so scoring uses a logistic regression, not an LLM (D8). It is deterministic, its coefficients are versioned in the repo, and it runs in the same TypeScript as everything else.

- **Inputs:** days overdue, outstanding, days since last payment, earlier lateness, broken and kept promises, open promise, days since last contact, times not reachable. All are point-in-time, and tests enforce that nothing after the scored day leaks in.
- **Ranking (A18):** loans at 1–30 days come first, because those can still be stopped from rolling. Within each group, most rupees at stake: probability × outstanding × 0.20 × 0.35, using the brief's NPA and loss rates (A10).
- **Reasons:** each is a real term of the model's sum, measured against a clean loan, so a reason is never shown for a fact that is not there. A loan with little history says so.

The first version mixed all stages and lost to a one-line rule, 59% to 88%. That back-test is why the stage ordering exists (D21). Results on a simulated world the model never saw (share of the rupees that rolled, inside each officer's first loans of the day):

First…	Model	Oldest first, 1–30 only	Oldest first (today's practice)
5 loans	**68.3%**	59.2%	0%
10 loans	**91.8%**	88.5%	16.7%

Limits, stated plainly. The data is synthetic (A9), so these figures show the method works on a simulation, not what it will do for this lender. It must be retrained on real history before go-live. Most of the gain comes from the stage rule; the model's own lead over that rule is real but modest. In the weekly back-test, the simple rule narrowly won one of the last eight weeks (84% vs 83%). The back-test shows the model targets the right loans. It does not prove a call would save them, which is why roll rate stays on the dashboard.

When the score is wrong: it is advisory and blocks nothing, the maths is on the loan screen, managers can reorder, and the dashboard's weekly back-test compares scores given with what those loans did thirty days later.

Reminder drafts: an LLM, fenced in

1. On the officer's tap, the server picks the approved template that fits the loan's latest promise.
2. The model receives only that template with its placeholders (such as `{borrowerName}`), the language and the situation. No name, number or note ever leaves, so there is no personal data to leak (DPDP) and no outside text to inject.
3. The reply must pass every check: word filter in English and Hindi, exactly the same placeholders, no invented numbers or links, length and language. Any failure, outage or missing key gives the officer the approved wording instead, labelled as such.
4. The officer reads it and taps Send. They cannot edit it, so what passed the checks is what goes out. Sending obeys the contact window and the daily limit, and every try is recorded (A27).

The call goes through OpenRouter, with free models tried in order and set by an environment variable. Testing showed why that order matters: the free router often picked a model that returned nothing in Hindi, so two models that wrote good Hindi come first. Because no personal data is sent, a free model that keeps prompts is acceptable. A successful draft is reused for that loan, language and day. A slow or rate-limited model only means the officer gets the approved wording, labelled as such.

7. The hard parts

Offline logging with sync

- **Append-only events with client UUIDs (D7).** Nothing is edited, so nothing needs merging. A retry stores nothing twice, including retries arriving at the same moment, which the database settles.

- **The screen tells the truth.** The list is the last server copy plus unsent events, so logged work shows at once and survives a reload. Anything the server later refuses stays visible with the reason. One invalid entry cannot jam the rest.
- **The app itself is cached** by a service worker, network-first with a 3-second timeout, because weak signal hangs rather than fails.
- **Personal data on the phone** stays in IndexedDB, scoped to the user, cleared on sign-out and expired after 7 days. Unsent work survives sign-out, because it is the only copy.

The 8 am–7 pm contact block

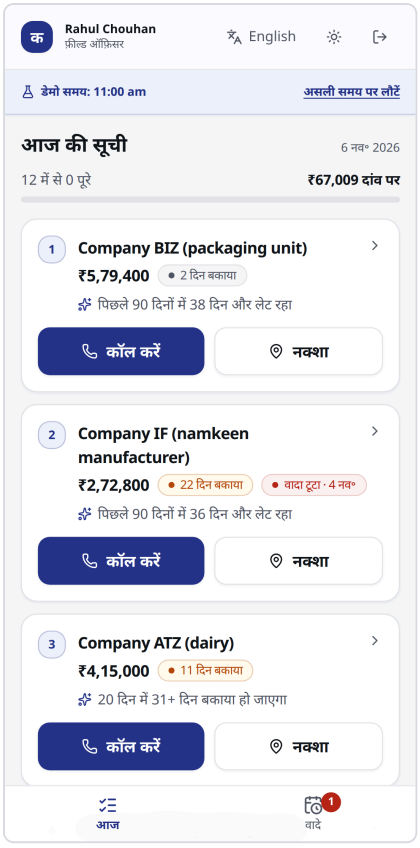
- **Judged by when it happened (D9).** A call at 18:50 synced at 21:00 is legitimate.
- **A wrong phone clock can't cheat (D20).** Each batch states what the phone's clock reads now, and the server corrects by the gap. Setting a phone back shifts both readings equally, so it changes nothing.
- **Blocked, explained, recorded.** A blocked tap tells the officer why and when contact opens, and is stored with its reason. An outcome can only stand on an allowed attempt.
- **The server has the final say,** along with a limit of 3 contacts per loan per day (A5).

8. Security and compliance

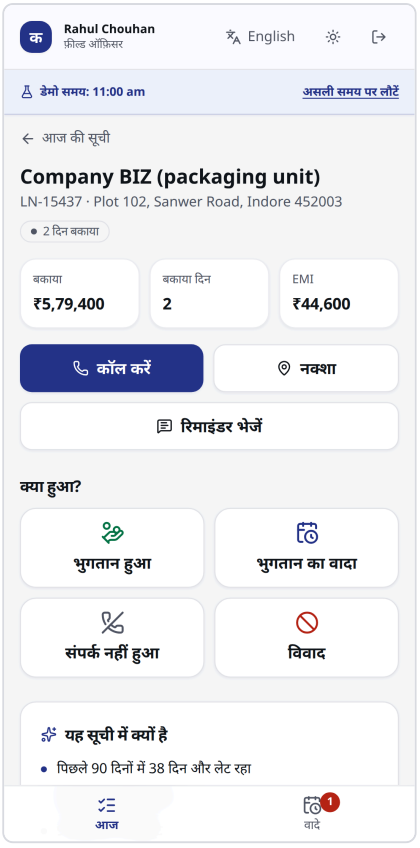
- **Access:** scoped per role in one module and tested per role. Sign-up is closed, and sign-in is rate-limited in Postgres, per address as recorded by the nearest trusted proxy (D29).
- **DPDP:** managers see masked phone numbers, and revealing one is audited. Officers get full numbers only for loans they hold (D19), because calls often work when data does not. The AI sees no personal data.
- **On the phone:** borrower data is cached in IndexedDB per user, cleared on sign-out, and expires after 7 days, which limits what a lost phone exposes. Unsent work stays until it is delivered, because it is the only copy.
- **Audit record:** managers download the contact log for up to 92 days: every attempt, blocked ones too, with loan numbers but no borrower details. Each download is itself audited, and text a spreadsheet would run as a formula is neutralised (A31, D33).
- **Location:** GPS is read once, only when an officer logs an attempt or outcome. The app never tracks officers continuously.
- **Retention:** uncommitted import previews are deleted after 24 hours (A24), and sign-in rate-limit records, which hold IP addresses, after a day. Production would add encryption at rest, backups, a retention policy for loan and contact records, and a process for data-subject requests.
- **What this is not:** this is a demo with the controls listed here, not a claim of legal compliance with the DPDP Act. That needs legal review and the lender's own processes.
- **Demo password:** it is public on purpose, in the repository and on the sign-in page, and only opens synthetic demo accounts.
- **Web:** an origin check on every change, every input validated by contract, and a Content-Security-Policy with nothing loading from elsewhere. It allows inline scripts: nonces would mean rendering every page per request, giving up the static shell that offline opening relies on (D30).

- **Repository:** no secrets and no real personal data. Borrowers are placeholders with fake numbers (A14).

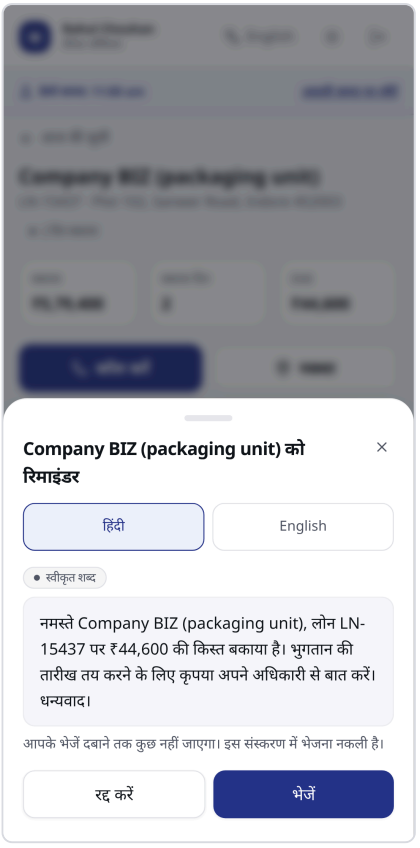
9. UI and design decisions



The list: why each loan is there, with Call and Map one tap away.

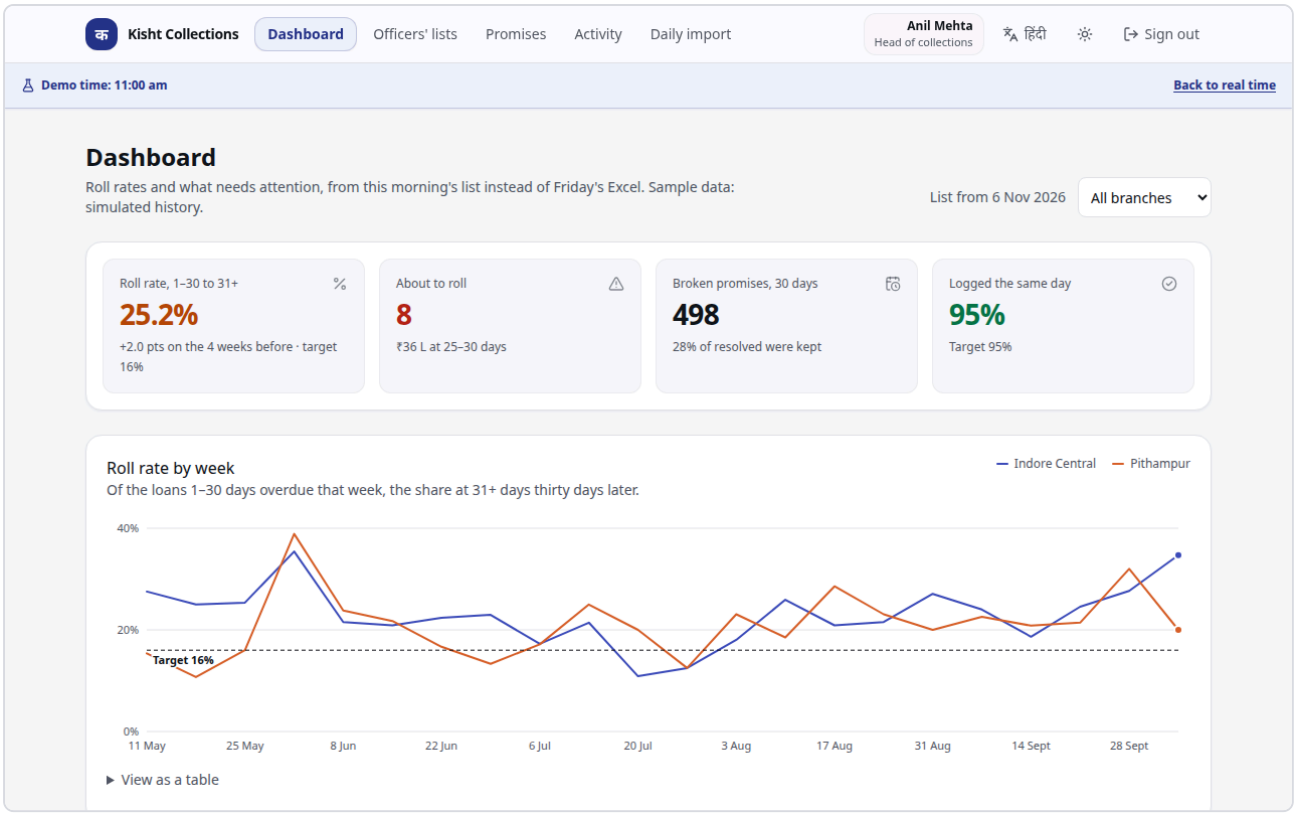


The loan: contact first, then four large outcome buttons within thumb reach.



The reminder: read it, choose a language, then decide.

- **One hand.** 48 px targets, bottom sheets instead of new pages, and a date chip that doubles as confirmation.
- **Restraint.** One accent colour, with status colours kept for meaning. Each colour also has words, so nothing relies on colour alone.
- **Low-end phones.** System fonts instead of web fonts saved 415 KB, more than all our code (D23). Charts are small hand-written SVGs with a table view (D25).
- **Hindi first for officers (A16),** with English one tap away, using a small typed dictionary that checks every key exists in both languages (D15).
- **Reviewers open apps at night,** when the rules block all contact. A clearly bannered demo clock, present only in demo mode, handles that (D13).



The head's question, answered: roll rate by branch against the 16% target, without waiting for Friday.

10. Testing

Layer	Count	What it proves
Business rules	158	Boundaries such as 18:59:59 vs 19:00:00 and the 90% promise line; threats in two languages. Coverage of at least 90% is enforced.
API integration	136	Access per role, CSRF, contracts, import re-uploads, sync retries at the same moment, an AI that misbehaves.
Database and seed	9	Partial unique indexes; the brief's sample rows exactly; roll rate near 22%.
Web units	12	The offline overlay and the day summary.
Browser (phone and desktop)	84	Real offline work reaching a manager, three-tap logging, the 7 pm block, and WCAG AA on every screen in both themes.

CI runs lint, strict types, all of the above and a production build on every push. Lighthouse measured accessibility at 100, and performance at 99 on sign-in and 83 on the officer's list on a slow first visit, after which it opens from the phone.

11. How I used AI

AI tools (Claude Code) drafted much of the code and these documents, searched the brief and the code for gaps, and reviewed changes. Their output went through the same tests and CI as everything else.

The judgement and the numbers are mine, and I can explain each one:

- **The model:** a logistic regression rather than an LLM, and its results. I checked the AUC (0.793, and 0.727 within 1–30 days) and the back-test against oldest-first, and I quote the conservative 68% rather than the 82% of recent weeks.
- **The rules:** the roll-rate definition (A6), the contact window by corrected time, 3 attempts a day, and disputes pausing contact.
- **The import check:** the 20% threshold for a file that may be incomplete, taken from the simulated history (A28).
- **Security:** access scoped per role, no personal data sent to the AI, and the Content-Security-Policy trade-off (D30).

AI output was not taken as given. An AI-assisted UI pass (f477dfe) added a dashboard banner with a fixed rupee figure, shrank tap targets, left new text untranslated and broke CI. The next commit (7b52704) removed what did not fit the brief and fixed the build.

12. What was cut, and what's next

Cut	Why
Sending the outbox while the app is fully closed	It would duplicate the send logic in the service worker, and officers keep the app open. Everything sends the next time it opens (A13).
Drafting a reminder with no signal	The server has to check every draft. Calls, visits and outcomes all work offline.
Cash receipts, legal notices, auto-dialling	Out of scope in the brief.

Known limits

- **The daily contact limit is per loan (A5).** A person with two loans could be contacted six times a day. The export has no borrower ID, so each loan gets its own borrower record, and matching on phone or name could wrongly merge different people. Counting per borrower, across loans and officers, is the next step once the loan system provides that ID.
- Not yet tried on a real low-end Android phone, and the Hindi needs a native speaker's read. Server error messages are in English only.
- The officer's list loads about 290 KB of JavaScript (gzip) the first time, against a 200 KB target; after that the service worker serves it from the phone. Manager pages are about 255 KB, because they no longer load the offline storage they never use. Replacing the storage library would save about 33 KB at the cost of hand-written code in the riskiest part of the app.

Next, within the brief's eight weeks

1. Retrain the model on the lender's real repayment history, and recheck against the back-test.
2. Pilot with one branch, measuring roll rate and same-day logging against the targets.
3. Connect a real SMS or WhatsApp gateway, which changes one function (D24), and have compliance approve the templates (A25).

4. Replace the CSV upload with a direct feed from the loan system once the pilot proves the workflow.

Appendix: every assumption

#	Assumption
A1	The daily overdue CSV has these columns: `loan_id, borrower_name, business_type, phone, address, pincode, outstanding, dpd, emi_amount, last_payment_date, last_payment_amount, branch_code`.
A2	There is one import per day. Re-uploading the same as-of date replaces that day's snapshot (the earlier batch is marked superseded). Days must be imported in order: a day older than the latest committed import is refused. A branch manager's upload applies only to their branch's rows; the head of collections imports all branches.
A3	An officer's territory is a set of pincodes. A loan stays with its current officer while that officer covers its pincode; otherwise it goes to the covering officer with the fewest loans. The 25-loan cap applies to the **daily list** (top 25 by priority), not to ownership.
A4	Contact is allowed from 08:00 to 18:59:59 IST, every day of the week.
A5	There are at most 3 contact attempts per loan per day. The limit is configurable.
A6	A loan "rolls" when it is 1–30 DPD on day D and 31+ DPD on day D+30.
A7	A promise is **kept** if payments of at least 90% of the promised amount arrive by the promise date + 1 day. Less than that, but more than zero, is **partial**. Nothing is **broken**.
A8	A payment is detected when `last_payment_date` moves forward (amount from `last_payment_amount`), or else when `outstanding` drops, dated the day before (export lag). A loan that **drops off** the overdue list is treated as cured: its arrears were cleared, so a pending promise on it counts as kept.
A9	The priority model is trained on synthetic history generated by the seeder. It must be retrained on the client's real repayment history before go-live.
A10	Of the loans that roll, 20% turn NPA, with a 35% loss given default. Both figures come from the brief, and they drive the rupee-at-risk figures.
A11	There are two branches: Indore Central (pincodes 4520xx) and Pithampur (454775 and nearby), with 6–8 officers including Rahul Chouhan, Neha Solanki and Imran Qureshi.
A12	A **Dispute** outcome pauses contact for that loan until a branch manager clears it.
A13	Officers use Android phones running Chrome. Sending happens while the app is open: at each log, when signal returns, when the app comes to the foreground, and on a timer.
A14	Borrowers are placeholders ("Company B (packaging unit)"), and phone numbers come from a fake 90000-xxxxx range.
A15	Seeded dates are relative to the day the seed runs. For example, LN-10293's promise falls in 3 days, and LN-11930's promise broke 2 days ago.
A16	The officer UI defaults to Hindi, with English available as a toggle. The manager UI defaults to English.
A17	Money is stored as whole rupees.

A18	List order: loans at 1–30 days overdue come first, then 31+. Within each, most rupees at stake first. At 1–30 that is P(roll) × outstanding × 0.07; at 31+ it is P(cure) × outstanding × 0.07.
A19	A loan with an open promise isn't chased until the promised date; it waits in its own section.
A20	"Paid" is recorded as reported by the officer and doesn't change any balance. The next import confirms it. A promise defaults to one EMI.
A21	A manager's move pins a loan's position for that day only, with a reason the officer sees. A manual assignment stays with that officer through later imports, even outside their pincodes.
A22	Borrowers are reminded at 10 am the day before and 9 am on the promised day; the officer at 8:30 am that day. Reminders stop once a promise settles or the loan is in dispute.
A23	"About to roll" means 25–30 days overdue on the latest list. A visit is flagged when it has no GPS fix or is over 500 m from the borrower's address.
A24	Import previews that are never committed are deleted after 24 hours.
A25	The two extra reminder templates (a missed promise, an overdue instalment with no promise) are our wording, and the lender's compliance team would approve them before use.
A26	"Nothing sends without the officer's tap" applies to AI drafts. The automatic promise reminders the brief also asks for go out on schedule, because they use fixed approved wording.
A27	A reminder message counts as a contact: it needs the 8 am–7 pm window and counts towards the limit of 3 contacts a day.
A28	If at least 5 loans and over 20% of the previous list are missing from a file, it may be incomplete, so a manager must confirm they are no longer overdue before it can commit. 20% comes from the simulated history, where normal days peak at 13.5% of a branch's list. It should be retuned on real data.
A29	If today's import is late, officers keep working the latest list, marked with its date, rather than an empty one. Managers are prompted to upload it. A day's calls on yesterday's list beat a blank screen, as long as the officer knows the figures are older.
A30	The evening message an officer sends from My day carries counts and rupee totals only, never borrower names or numbers. It counts entries still on the phone, and says how many are unsent. "Paid" there is as reported; the next import confirms it.
A31	The contact log export covers up to 92 days of IST days at a time, 30 by default, and identifies loans by number, not by borrower name or phone. Each download is recorded in the audit log.
A32	Against the previous list, a loan is new if it wasn't on it, new to you if its assignment started on or after the latest list's day (by a manager if manual), and part paid if a later payment is reported. The first list marks nothing.